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Digital Asset Management~ Managing Content

Digital Asset Management or DAM refers to efficient archiving, retrieving and distributing of information such as images, multimedia, documents, etc. DAM ensures that the information is not lost and also increases efficiency and reduces costs due to easier access to information. Using DAM, a media house can easily collate information on a specific topic that has been generated internally over the years. Many digital asset management tools also allow users to access, update and manage image, audio, video and text files from anywhere in the world using the Internet as a connectivity tool.

Digital Rights Management (DRM) is also made simple with DAM systems. DRM allows creators of content (media houses, music companies, movie studios, etc) the freedom to protect their content against the Napster kind of attacks. DRM encodes content and only registered users (either free or on a payment basis) will get access to the content. Counters will monitor the number of times the content has been accessed and payment systems will be built around that.

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Robotics~ Extra-terrestrial intelligence

Artificial Intelligence and wireless technologies have evolved 'smart robots' that can communicate with each other and also be controlled from remote access. A doctor can use robots to perform surgical operations and control the movements from a distant location or using augmented reality to derive more information from the surrounding environment. Smart robots, which are very capable, are now being used for underwater explorations and research in hazardous areas. At the same time, robots are the new age entertainment devices, jumping around and aping human movements. Apart from the obvious use in mass-production, robots will help businesses for research purposes, act as a help for many household chores, and do more than just play with kids.

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Web services~Go online

Gartner forecasts that by 2003, Web services will occupy over 75 per cent of the Web server space.

Web services allow various applications to work together using similar data formats. Businesses can quickly translate these advantages into automated services that allow for closer and tighter relationships with various trading partners and customers by sharing information even if their platforms are different.

ASPs will enable use of software installed on some application server, remote monitoring of networks, etc. Web services have the potential to communicate across applications; they can cross over the bounds of hardware as well. With Microsoft pushing .Net, integrated services will be the order of the day.